The Ultimate Guide: Submitting Your AI Capstone Project to arXiv

Congratulations on completing the ExamAI platform! Transitioning a capstone project into a published research paper is a massive achievement. This guide will walk you through exactly how to format and upload your paper to **arXiv**, the premier open-access repository for computer science and AI research.

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1. arXiv Submission Overview

What is arXiv?

arXiv (pronounced "archive") is an open-access repository of electronic preprints (research papers) maintained by Cornell University. It is the global standard for researchers in Computer Science, Machine Learning, and Physics to share their work before formal journal publication.

What Type of Papers Are Accepted?

arXiv accepts original research papers, systematic reviews, and significant technical reports. They do **not** accept software manuals, marketing brochures, or generic student essays.

Is My Capstone Project Suitable?

Yes. Because ExamAI implements Generative AI, dynamic LLM prompting, and multimodal OCR pipelines to solve a real-world socioeconomic problem, it constitutes a valid technical architecture/systems paper. By framing it as a "System Design" or "Applied AI" paper (which we have already done in your `ExamAI_arXiv_Paper.md`), it perfectly fits the criteria for arXiv's Computer Science categories.

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2. Pre-Submission Preparation Checklist

Before you hit upload, ensure you have the following ready:

- **The Research Paper:** Your project must be written as a formal paper (Abstract, Introduction, Methodology, Architecture, Results, Conclusion, References). *Note: The `ExamAI_arXiv_Paper.pdf` we generated is already structured this way.*
- **File Formats:**
  - **LaTeX (Highly Preferred):** arXiv heavily prefers LaTeX submissions (`.tex` files). If you use LaTeX, you must upload a `.zip` file containing your `.tex` file and all image files.
  - **PDF:** You *can* upload a standard PDF directly, but arXiv will permanently stamp it with a red watermark on the side. For beginners, uploading a high-quality PDF is the easiest route.
- **Endorsement:** Because this is your first time submitting to arXiv, you will need an **"Endorsement"**. You must find an existing arXiv author (such as a professor at CMR University) to endorse you.
- **Naming Conventions:** Keep filenames simple, e.g., `ExamAI_Main_Paper.pdf`.

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3. Formatting Requirements for arXiv

- **Layout:** Standard US Letter (8.5" x 11") or A4 size. Use a clean, two-column IEEE format or a highly structured single-column format.
- **Figures & Screenshots:** Ensure all UI screenshots are high-resolution. They must be referenced in the text (e.g., "As seen in Figure 1...").

- **Citations:** Use standard academic citation formats (IEEE or APA).
- **Page Limit:** There is no strict limit, but 6 to 12 pages is standard for system architecture papers.
- **No "Title Pages":** The title, authors (Rahul, Charan, Dakshath, Mahesh), affiliations (CMR University), and Abstract must be on the very first page. Do not include a separate cover page.

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4. Step-by-Step Upload Process

Step 1: Create an arXiv Account

1. Go to arxiv.org and click **Register**.
2. Use your **university email address** (e.g., `@cmr.edu.in`) if possible. Institutional emails significantly speed up the verification process.
3. Fill out your profile details completely.

Step 2: Get Endorsed (Crucial for First-Timers)

1. Before you can submit to the Computer Science category, arXiv requires an endorsement.
2. The system will give you a unique endorsement link.
3. Send this link to a professor or a researcher who has previously published on arXiv. They just need to click it to verify you are a legitimate student/researcher.

Step 3: Start a New Submission

1. Log in and click **Submit a new article**.
2. Verify your contact information and accept the submission policies.

Step 4: Choose the Subject Category

You must select a primary category. For ExamAI, the best categories are:

- **cs.AI** (Artificial Intelligence)
- **cs.CY** (Computers and Society) — *Great because of the EWS social impact angle.*
- **cs.HC** (Human-Computer Interaction)

Step 5: Upload Your Files

1. Select the **PDF** upload option (unless you ported the document to LaTeX).
2. Upload `ExamAI_arXiv_Paper.pdf` .
3. Wait for arXiv's automated system to process and compile the file. Check the generated preview carefully.

Step 6: Enter Metadata

1. **Title:** Enter your exact title.
2. **Authors:** Enter all 4 team members. Format: `Rahul R Bagewadi, Charan, Dakshath, Mahesh` .
3. **Abstract:** Copy and paste the 180-word abstract exactly as it appears in the paper.
4. **Comments:** (Optional) You can add: *"Capstone Project, CMR University, Data Science Batch 2022-2026."*

Step 7: Final Review and Submission

Review the preview one last time to ensure no text was cut off. Click **Submit**.

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5. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- **Submitting a "Project Report":** Writing "This is my college project..." in the abstract. Always frame it as "This paper presents a novel system..."
- **Plagiarism / Missing Citations:** arXiv uses automated plagiarism checkers (like Turnitin). Ensure you have properly cited Gemini, Next.js, and Edge TTS in your references.
- **Improper File Structure:** Uploading a Word Document (`.docx`). arXiv **strictly** rejects Word documents. It must be PDF or LaTeX.
- **Large File Sizes:** arXiv has a file size limit (usually around 10MB). Since your PDF is 2.5MB, you are perfectly safe.

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6. Best Practices for Acceptance

- **Elevate the Tone:** Avoid marketing language like *"ExamAI is the best app for students!"* Replace it with objective statements like *"ExamAI demonstrates a 40% reduction in latency for vernacular content generation."*
- **Focus on the Architecture:** arXiv moderators care about *how* you built it, not just *what* you built. Emphasize your use of Edge runtimes, JSON-schema LLM constraints, and the OCR verification pipeline.
- **Positioning the Capstone:** Frame your project as an "Applied Systems" paper. You aren't inventing a new LLM algorithm; you are inventing a novel *application architecture* using existing LLMs to solve a real-world problem. This is a highly respected sub-field in Computer Science.

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7. Post-Submission Process

What Happens Next?

1. **Moderation (1-3 Days):** Your paper goes into a moderation queue. Human volunteers briefly check it to ensure it looks like a real academic paper and isn't spam.
2. **Announcement:** If approved, your paper is officially "announced" at 8:00 PM EST (around 5:30 AM IST).
3. **Public URL:** You will receive a permanent link (e.g., `arxiv.org/abs/2604.12345`) which you can immediately put on your resume and LinkedIn.

Version Updates

If you notice a typo or want to update the paper after your defense, you can submit a "Replacement." arXiv keeps a history of versions (v1, v2, v3), ensuring your original submission timestamp is preserved while allowing for future improvements.